FREE CHECKLIST · November 2026

E-commerce SEO Checklist

40 concrete checks for your online store, from category and product pages to faceted navigation, out-of-stock items, campaign URLs and product data.

6 sections · 40 checks

How to use this checklist

Work through the items in order and test each one on your highest-traffic category and product templates. 'High' items directly affect indexing and revenue, so fix them first; schedule 'medium' items for the next sprint and handle 'low' items when you have capacity.

Priority: **High** **Medium** **Low**

01 Category pages

- [ ] **Publish each main category on a single, permanent, readable URL; if the same category is reachable via several paths, point the others to the canonical URL.** High
  How: Check 'Google-selected canonical' in Search Console URL Inspection; list duplicate category URLs with a crawler such as Screaming Frog.
- [ ] **Write category title tags and H1s to match the most-searched phrase for that category.** High
  How: Filter the category URL in the Search Console Performance report and compare its title with the query that earns the most impressions.
- [ ] **Add a short, original intro to each category page that helps shoppers and does not push the product grid down.** Medium
  How: Open the page on mobile: products should be visible on the first screen; compare the copy with other categories using a duplicate-content checker.
- [ ] **Verify that every category is reachable within three clicks from the main menu and breadcrumbs.** Medium
  How: Open the crawl depth report in your crawler and list category URLs deeper than 3 clicks.
- [ ] **Show breadcrumbs on all category and product pages and mark them up with BreadcrumbList structured data.** Low
  How: Test one category and one product URL in the Rich Results Test; confirm the Breadcrumbs report in Search Console shows no errors.
- [ ] **Either fill empty category pages with products or remove them and 301-redirect to the closest parent category.** Low
  How: Filter category URLs with zero products in your crawl data; check the 'Soft 404' row in the Search Console Pages report.

02 Product pages

- [ ] **Write a unique description for each product covering use, dimensions and differences instead of copying the manufacturer's text.** — High
  How: Search a sentence from the description in quotes on Google; rewrite it if it appears verbatim on other sites.
- [ ] **Use brand, model and the distinguishing attribute (colour, capacity, etc.) in product titles following a consistent pattern.** — Medium
  How: Export the product list and filter the title column against the pattern; fix rows missing brand or model.
- [ ] **Give every product at least one high-resolution image that clearly shows the product and loads via a crawlable <img> tag.** — High
  How: In URL Inspection, use 'View tested page' and find the image src in the rendered HTML; make sure it is not a CSS background.
- [ ] **Give product images alt text that describes the product and use meaningful file names (e.g. red-leather-backpack.jpg).** — Medium
  How: Open your crawler's 'images missing alt text' report and check the alt attribute on product template images.
- [ ] **Add Product structured data to product pages including name, image and offers (price, priceCurrency, availability).** — High
  How: Test a product URL in the Rich Results Test; confirm the Merchant listings and Product snippets reports in Search Console show no errors.
- [ ] **Verify that price and availability in structured data exactly match the price and stock shown on the page.** — High
  How: Pick a discounted product and compare the price value in the Rich Results Test with the price on the page.
- [ ] **Display genuine customer reviews on the page as HTML; use review markup only for reviews visible on the page.** — Medium
  How: Check that review text appears in the page source; compare aggregateRating with the rating and review count shown on the page.
- [ ] **Link from product pages to the parent category, similar products and complementary products using crawlable <a href> links.** — Low
  How: In the rendered HTML, check that links in the 'similar products' block are <a href> elements, not JavaScript onclick handlers.

03 Faceted navigation, parameters and pagination

- [ ] **Identify filter combinations with search demand (e.g. 'men's running shoes') and open only those to indexing; block or noindex the rest.** — High
  How: Check search volume for filter phrases in a keyword tool; list the filter URLs you will keep indexable in a sheet.
- [ ] **Block crawling of filter and sort URLs you do not want indexed via robots.txt.** — High
  How: Confirm the file is fetched in the Search Console robots.txt report; test a sample filter URL in URL Inspection to see it is blocked.
- [ ] **Keep the order of filter parameters in the URL fixed and prevent the same filter from being added twice.** — Medium
  How: Select the same two filters in different orders and confirm in the address bar that the URL is identical both times.

- [ ] **Return an HTTP 404 status code at the same URL when a filter combination returns no results.** Medium
  How: Open an empty filter URL with the Network tab of browser developer tools open and check the status code.
- [ ] **Verify that URLs with UTM, session ID or tracking parameters have a canonical tag pointing to the parameter-free version.** Medium
  How: Append ?utm_source=test to a product URL and check the rel=canonical value in the page source.
- [ ] **Give each paginated category page a unique URL (e.g. ?page=2) and a self-referencing canonical; do not canonicalise them all to page 1.** High
  How: Check rel=canonical in the source of pages 2 and 3; each should point to its own URL.
- [ ] **Use <a href> links for pagination; if you use 'Load more' or infinite scroll, confirm each page also has its own reachable URL.** Medium
  How: Open the category page with JavaScript disabled and check that the link to the next page works.
- [ ] **Do not rely on rel="next"/"prev", which Google no longer uses; provide navigation between pages through visible links.** Low
  How: Check in the source that pagination links appear in the page body, not only in <link rel=next>.

04 Variants and stock status

- [ ] **Decide whether variants such as colour and size live on one page or on separate pages per variant, and apply that consistently across the catalogue.** Medium
  How: Compare variant URLs and canonical tags for five products from different categories in a sheet.
- [ ] **For single-page variants, provide a distinct URL parameter that preselects each variant and use one canonical URL for the whole group.** Medium
  How: Open a variant URL directly; check the right image, price and stock are preselected and the canonical is the base product URL.
- [ ] **Group variants with ProductGroup markup (hasVariant, variesBy, productGroupID) and give each variant a unique sku or gtin.** Medium
  How: Test the product URL in the Rich Results Test and confirm ProductGroup and its variant items are detected.
- [ ] **Keep pages for temporarily out-of-stock products live, return 200 and set availability to OutOfStock.** High
  How: Check the availability value of an out-of-stock product in the Rich Results Test and its 200 status in the Network tab.
- [ ] **301-redirect permanently discontinued products to a direct replacement if one exists; otherwise return 404 or 410.** High
  How: Match the discontinued product list against your redirect map and make sure nothing is bulk-redirected to the homepage.
- [ ] **Add similar-product recommendations and a 'notify me when back in stock' option to out-of-stock product pages.** Low
  How: Open an out-of-stock product page on mobile and check the recommendation block and notify form appear near the top.

05 Internal search and campaign pages

- [ ] **Block internal search result pages via robots.txt or keep them out of the index with noindex.** Medium
  How: Run site:yourdomain.com inurl:search (with your own search parameter) on Google; it should return no results.
- [ ] **Find frequently searched terms with no matching page in internal search data and create category or content pages for them.** Low
  How: Export internal search terms in GA4 (view_search_results event, search_term parameter) and flag terms with no matching page.
- [ ] **Use a permanent URL without a year (e.g. /black-friday) for seasonal campaigns such as Black Friday or Mother's Day and update the same URL every year.** High
  How: List past campaign URLs and 301-redirect old year-specific URLs to the permanent URL.
- [ ] **Do not delete the campaign page when the campaign ends; keep it live with the next campaign date and featured products.** Medium
  How: After the campaign ends, check the URL still returns 200 and keeps a link from the main menu or footer.
- [ ] **Publish the campaign page at least a few weeks before the campaign and link to it from the homepage.** Medium
  How: After publishing, confirm the page is indexed with Search Console URL Inspection and request indexing if needed.

06 Product data, Merchant Center and speed

- [ ] **Set up a Google Merchant Center account, verify and claim your website, and submit product data via a feed or structured data.** Medium
  How: In Merchant Center, check that your website shows as verified and claimed under your business information.
- [ ] **Review and fix disapproved products or products with reported issues in Merchant Center every week.** Medium
  How: Filter the Merchant Center product list by status and start with the issue affecting the most products.
- [ ] **Verify that price, availability, GTIN and brand in the feed match the product page and structured data.** High
  How: Pick 10 random products from the feed and compare the values with the product page and Rich Results Test output.
- [ ] **Define your shipping and return policies in Merchant Center or with OfferShippingDetails / MerchantReturnPolicy markup.** Low
  How: Check shipping and return settings in Merchant Center, or confirm these fields are detected in the Rich Results Test.
- [ ] **Verify that category and product templates meet the 'good' Core Web Vitals thresholds: LCP ≤ 2.5 s, INP ≤ 200 ms, CLS ≤ 0.1.** High
  How: Review mobile URL groups in the Search Console Core Web Vitals report and test one URL per template in PageSpeed Insights.
- [ ] **Serve product images as WebP or AVIF at sizes suited to the screen and lazy-load those below the fold.** Medium
  How: Check image-related suggestions in PageSpeed Insights and confirm the main product image does not use loading="lazy".

- [ ] **List third-party scripts on product pages (live chat, reviews, marketing tags) and remove unused ones.** Low
  How: Filter by third-party domains in the Chrome DevTools Network tab and review active tags in your tag manager.

Detailed guides

E-commerce SEO guide
How to write e-commerce product descriptions
Black Friday SEO
Crawl budget
E-commerce platform SEO comparison
Schema and structured data guide
Schema generator

Need a second pair of eyes on your site? Book a free intro call:
fatihemincakiroglu.com/en/book-a-call

This checklist reflects publicly documented Google guidance as of November 2026. Search features change; check the official documentation before major decisions.